

## A bird? a plane? No it's...

A tumbling UARC satellite is captured by an amateur astronomer

## Radeon 7000 postponed

Radeon has pushed the launch of its 7000 series cards to next year

a messenger. After opening the packaging, I find a yellow coloured, beautifully written 'nano' book named Fast Track to Nanotechnology. Thanks a lot for it, I love you guys. I had spent ₹400 for a book on the subject, but let me tell you, this is far better. Keep up the good work, gurus.

*Prateek Arora*

**d** Glad you liked the Fast Track. I request all readers who want more such topics to drop me a line, and even send in suggestions for what you want. God's a little busy, and might not be able to play messenger all the time. :-)

*Robert*

✉ I've been a regular reader of Digit and I love it. I really love the concept of more Fast Tracks but not so much the DVDs. At the same time, I understand that there's an equal number of people who think the other way round. As much as I'm tempted to ask for two FTs and multiple DVDs (you guys have spoiled us over the years), it is my incessant wish that the quality of content be maintained. Therefore, I hope you alternate between the two. One month you can have two FTs and the next, two DVDs. More than being an amicable, please-all solution, it would help you in delivering content of better quality since you get more time to research content which appeals to the masses instead of producing not-so-great (read: FB, Google+, BlackBerry) Fast Tracks. Also, an extra DVD with great content is far more appealing than cramming mediocre distros/videos etc. To top it off, I would like to add that over time, Fast Tracks have become more text-bookeey on some topics and lost their soul (or so I feel). I sincerely hope you understand what I'm trying to convey. All the best.

*Govind Raveendran*

**d** Excellent feedback, and yes you have hit the nail on the head. I also think that the Fast Tracks have focused a little too much on making things easier to understand rather than maintaining the humorous writing style of Digit. I'm currently trying to fix this, so that although still easy to understand, the FTs get easier to read as well.

*Robert*

## LETTER OF THE MONTH

### Change track...

✉ While I was reading the magazine, I was at the Letters to the Editor section when I read about the change in the magazine regarding the DVDs and Fast Track booklets. Quite frankly, I never have the time or patience to go through the DVDs that you send. Any software that I need, I just download off the internet, and, sorry to say this, but I find the rest of the content on the DVDs very unappealing. That said, I realised that you've been giving two Fast Track booklets each month and just one DVD. Firstly, that is more eco-friendly (paper degrades better than plastic, of course) and secondly, it seems to be the better thing to do in terms of content.

I heartily welcome the move of more textual content, than DVDs. The one thing to note however is that the writing style of the Fast Track is quite unimpressive - it looks like you're trying to cram in text without focusing on grammar and the language. So having an additional Fast Track is not necessarily a *good* thing.

On the other hand, you could drop one of the DVDs, have just a single Fast Track (let's keep the booklet as an exclusive per month), and instead have more content on the magazine.

Have additional content where you review web sites, and web services instead of just providing links to each and every article on the web (when I'm reading a magazine, I'd rather just read it, than having to sit in front of an internet-enabled PC to follow the links that you've strewn about the magazine). The World View section is quite good and you can add some more content there. Also try to give more hardware-related content, including designs of processor and motherboard technology etc. All said and done, a bit of change every now and then is always refreshing and helps keep the attention and curiosity of the reader.

*Prashanth K S*

**d** I think you're citing personal tastes more than a general observation. Not everyone in India lives in a city and has a broadband connection. The DVDs and Fast Tracks are equally important to most readers - based on our survey responses. However, I do agree that our writing styles and quality of copy-editing need to improve. We are actually very guilty of doing way more than we should attempt to - perhaps we need to stop striving to do so much, and opt to do it better instead.

*Robert*

✉ I've been reading Digit for the past few months and am now planning to subscribe to it. I really like your magazine and the articles in it. The September 2011 issue was also superb and the Fast Track on Nanotechnology was supreme which I liked the most. I appreciate the idea of one DVD instead of two, for which we get two Fast Tracks in return. I request that you also provide Fast Tracks on 'Artificial Intelligence' and 'Augmented Reality' which are the two upcoming buzzwords.

*Arpan Rewatkar*

**d** Look for them in the upcoming months. We do have a plan to do these topics in some form or another soon. We've also done a lot of such content in

the past, and that's why the archives we give away are so popular.

*Robert*

✉ Please rip Adobe Collection (all) trial software, All-in-one Security Suites trial, Macromedia Auto Cad and Windows 7 Ultimate trial version to the DVDs. I'm 200 per cent sure that everybody will buy this edition.

*Kumar Gaurav*

**d** We have provided all these trials on the DVD previously, and they're all so large that nothing else would fit. Given that we've got such a diverse readership, with hundreds of different tastes in software, we don't think it would be possible to do it all in one DVD, but we will put out updated versions when they're available.

*Sambhav*